

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

5. Project Development Phase

This phase contains the actual implementation activities performed in ServiceNow.

5.1 Service Configuration

Step 1: Create Service

Navigate to:

All → cmdb_ci_service.list → New

Enter:

Field	Value
Name	Remote Access
Operational Status	Operational

Submit the record.

Step 2: Create Service Offering

Navigate to:

All → service_offering.list → New

Enter:

Field	Value
Name	Corporate VPN
Parent	Remote Access
Operational Status	Operational

Submit the record.

5.2 Incident Creation

Navigate to:

Service Operations Workspace → List → Incidents → Open → New

Create an incident with:

Field	Value
Short Description	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office
Caller	Michael Hoefer
Assignment Group	Service Desk

Save the incident.

5.3 Incident Classification

Update the incident with:

Field	Value
Description	Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.
Channel	Phone
Category	Network
Subcategory	VPN
Urgency	2 – Medium
Service	Remote Access
Service Offering	Corporate VPN
Configuration Item	ThinkStationS20

Add the following work note:

Classified and assigned incident.

Then select **Assign to me** and save.

5.4 Agent Assist Implementation

Open **Agent Assist** from the right-side panel.

Verify that relevant Knowledge Articles are displayed based on the incident's short description.

Perform the following:

1. Open a relevant Knowledge Article.
2. Select the three-dot menu.
3. Mark the article as **Helpful**.
4. Select **Attach Article**.
5. Add the comment:

Follow the steps and resolve the incident.

6. Attach the article.
7. Return to the incident.
8. Verify that the article is recorded in the Activity log.

5.5 Watch List Configuration

In the incident **Details** tab:

- Add **Samantha Bordwell** to Watch List.
- Add **Beth Anglin** to Work Notes List.

This ensures that relevant stakeholders receive updates and can monitor the incident.

5.6 Incident Reassignment

Update:

Assignment Group → **Network**

Verify that the **Assigned To** field is cleared automatically when the assignment group changes.

Save the incident.

5.7 Level 2 Investigation

Impersonate the Level 2 Network technician.

Navigate to:

Service Operations Workspace → Incidents → Open

Open the VPN incident.

Select **Assign to me**.

Verify:

- Incident description is available.
- Knowledge Articles are available.
- SLA information is visible.
- Task SLAs appear in Related Records.
- Incident information is accessible to the Network team.

5.8 Emergency Change Integration

Update the Configuration Item as required.

Place the incident in:

State: On Hold

On Hold Reason: Awaiting Change

Create or associate the required emergency change request with the incident.

The change request provides controlled implementation of the technical fix while maintaining traceability between the incident and change.

5.9 Child Incident Creation

Navigate to:

Related Records → Child Incidents → New

Enter:

Field	Value
Short Description	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN
Caller	Any available user
Description	User receiving VPN authentication failure error

Save the record.

Record the child incident number.

Return to the parent incident and verify that the child incident appears under **Related Records**.

5.10 Cause Documentation

From the Overview tab, select **Add Cause**.

Enter:

Probable Cause:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

Save the cause information.

5.11 Resolution Documentation

Select **Add Resolution**.

Enter:

Field	Value
Resolution Code	Workaround provided
Resolution Notes	Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

Save the resolution.

Select **Resolve** and confirm the resolution.

5.12 Knowledge Article Creation

After resolving the incident, select **Create Knowledge**.

Configure:

Field	Value
Knowledge Base	IT
Article Template	Standard

Select **Next**.

Verify the incident and resolution details.

Save the Knowledge Article.

Return to the parent incident and navigate to:

Related Records → Knowledge

Verify that the newly created Knowledge Article is linked to the incident.

5.13 Testing and Validation

The implemented solution should be tested against the complete incident lifecycle.

Test Case 1 – Incident Creation

Expected Result:

Incident should be successfully created with caller and short description.

Test Case 2 – Classification

Expected Result:

Category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering, and CI should be correctly populated.

Test Case 3 – Knowledge Integration

Expected Result:

Relevant Knowledge Articles should appear in Agent Assist and should be attachable to the incident.

Test Case 4 – Reassignment

Expected Result:

Incident should move from Service Desk to Network support.

Test Case 5 – SLA

Expected Result:

Applicable SLA should be visible under Task SLAs.

Test Case 6 – Change Integration

Expected Result:

Emergency Change Request should be linked to the incident.

Test Case 7 – Child Incident

Expected Result:

Child incident should be created and displayed under the parent incident.

Test Case 8 – Resolution

Expected Result:

Cause and resolution information should be recorded and the incident should move to Resolved.

Test Case 9 – Knowledge Creation

Expected Result:

A Knowledge Article should be created from the resolved incident and linked to it.

5.14 Final Validation Checklist

At the end of development and testing, verify:

- ☒ Parent incident is **Resolved**.
- ☒ Child incident is **Resolved**.
- ☒ Incident activity contains the resolution information.
- ☒ Change Request is linked.
- ☒ Knowledge Article is created.
- ☒ Knowledge Article is linked to the incident.
- ☒ SLA tracking is visible.
- ☒ Assignment and reassignment work correctly.
- ☒ Incident classification is accurate.
- ☒ Watch List and Work Notes List are populated.
- ☒ Parent-child incident relationship is maintained.
- ☒ Complete incident history is available.